

ACTIVITY 10

LEVELS:

Grade 12, University Preparation

COURSES:

Canada and World Issues
HEV.02, HEV.03, HE1.03, HE2.05,
HE3.03, UCV.01, UC3.04, UC3.05

TASK:

In a group, analyze and compare country data and develop a plan of action on sustainable development for various countries.

EXPECTATIONS:

The student will:

- Analyse the impact of human activities on the environment in different regions of the world.
- Evaluate approaches, policies, and principles relating to the protection and sustainability of the planet's life-support systems.
- Analyse, forecast, and evaluate changes in the human use of the earth and its resources
- Produce an action plan for a country that contributes to the sustainability of a selected global resource.

TIMEFRAME:

55 Minutes

ACHIEVEMENT CATEGORIES:

Knowledge / Understanding

Thinking / Inquiry

Communication

Application / Making Connections

MATERIALS:

Country Profiles for Canada, Cameroon and Nicaragua; flipchart paper and markers

Action Plan and Recommendations for a Country Rubric

VOCABULARY:

Emissions

Imports and exports

Per capita

Indicators

GDP

Biodiversity



Sustainable Development around the World

PROCEDURE

Divide the class into groups of 4-5

Give each group a copy of Supplementary Sheets 1 to 3: Cameroon Country Profile, Canada Country Profile and Nicaragua Country Profile. Your students will also need Appendix 3 which was used in Unit 1: Sustainable Development Criteria.

Step 1

Have students work in groups to analyze the current status of each country in terms of the dimensions of sustainable development: economic, environmental and social. Students record their information on Worksheet 11. Discuss the differences among the levels of development, environmental problems, use of energy, etc so students begin to see the differences in levels of sustainability between countries.

When finished, have each group report back to the class on their most significant findings with regards to sustainable development.

Step 2

Next, assign each group one of the selected countries for further research. The group will take on the role of a development organization interested in selecting some sustainable development goals that are appropriate for their selected country, based on the current status of the economic, environmental and social dimensions. Appendix 3 on sustainable development is a useful reference. Have the students consider which goals they should begin with and what their countries will need to get started. (Money obviously, but what other

elements would be needed?) Record the goals and other comments on the worksheet.

After students have chosen some goals, have each group reports its goals and discuss them.

- Do any of the groups have similar goals?
- What are the differences?
- Should the goals be different for countries that have different levels of development?
- Does one country have more responsibility than others do for sustainable development?

Step 3

Students return to their groups and identify how they might achieve each goal they have set for their country. For example, if the group identified improve water quality as a goal, they should describe how this will be achieved. For instance, they might identify health and hygiene education as a way of improving water quality or the construction of a water filtration process.

As a conclusion, show the students some of the projects that the Canadian International Development Agency (CIDA) and other NGOs manage in the profiled countries (See Appendix 6). As well as some of Canada's objectives of Sustainable Development and some of it's Energy Policies. (See Appendices 7 and 8)

http://www.tbs-sct.gc.ca/pubs_pol/partners/sds-sdd1_e.html